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ROTOR AND ASSOCIATED ELECTRIC MACHINE, MOTOR COMPRESSOR AND MAGNETIC COUPLING

Abstract

Provided is a rotor and an electric machine, motor compressor and a magnetic coupling including the rotor, the rotor includes a cylindrical stack of laminations including at least a first and a second group of slots arranged to form a first and a second pole, magnetic flux barriers arranged at each end of each slot of the first and second groups of slots, two half shafts enclosing the stack and forming a shaft of the rotor, the rotor being a non-through shaft rotor, two non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disks, each end disk being interposed between one end of the stack and a half shaft, and a first set of tie rods connecting the two half shafts to keep the laminations of the stack compacted between the half-shafts, each tie rod of the first set being arranged between two adjacent slots of the first or second groups of slots.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application claims priority to European Patent Application Serial Number EP24151193.0, filed Jan. 10, 2024, which is herein incorporated by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present invention relates permanent magnets rotors, a magnetic coupling and an electric machine comprising such rotors, and a motor compressor comprising such an electric machine.

BACKGROUND

[0003] It is known that the power density of an electric machine depends on the magnetic flux generated by the rotor and the stator of the electric machine.

[0004] For a permanent magnet rotor, the magnetic flux generated by the rotor is proportional to the volume of magnets of the rotor.

[0005] It is also known that the power density of an electric machine increases linearly by increasing linearly the rotation speed of the rotor.

[0006] It is known to arrange permanent magnets in a rotor comprising a central hole so that each permanent magnet extends between the central hole and the periphery of the rotor.

[0007] The permanent magnets are arranged regularly in the rotor to concentrate the magnetic flux (flux concentration rotor type).

[0008] The document US 2009/0224624 discloses a permanent magnet rotor comprising a shaft enclosing a magnetic mass comprising multilayers of permanent magnets (multi layers rotor type).

[0009] The magnetic mass comprises stacked rotor laminations including a first group of slots and a second group of slots arranged to form a pole, and a center hole lodging the rotor shaft.

[0010] The first group of slots is arranged to form a magnetic flux along a direct axis of the pole resulting from the first and second group of slots.

[0011] The second group of slots is arranged to provide a separation for the magnetic flux from adjacent poles and lying along a quadrature axis of said pole.

[0012] Some of the first and second group of slots are arranged to receive permanent magnets, maximizing the quadrature inductance versus the direct inductance leading to create reluctance torque on top of interaction torque produced by magnets and currents injected in a stator encompassing the rotor to maximize the torque generated by the rotor.

[0013] In the rotors known from the prior art, as the shaft goes through the magnetic mass to lodge the shaft, the volume of magnets arranged in the magnetic mass is limited.

[0014] Further, the rotation speed of the rotor is limited to reduce the centrifuge forces acting on the rotor laminations in order to limit the constraints on the periphery of the center hole of the rotor laminations.

[0015] The constraints on the center holes may shear the rotor laminations.

[0016] The rotation speed of the rotor may be chosen so that the peripheral speed of the rotor does not exceed 200 m.Math.s.sup.-1.

[0017] It is therefore proposed to overcome wholly or partially these disadvantages.

SUMMARY

[0018] In view of the foregoing, the invention provides a rotor includes a cylindrical stack of laminations having at least a first group of slots and a second group of slots arranged to form a first pole, the first group of slots being arranged to form a magnetic flux along a direct axis of the pole resulting from the first and second group of slots, at least some of the first group of slots comprising first permanent magnets, the second group of slots being arranged to provide a separation for the magnetic flux from adjacent poles and lying along a quadrature axis of said pole, at least some slots of the second group of slots comprising first permanent magnets, and at least a second pole, the first pole and the second pole forming a pair of poles of the rotor.

[0019] According to an embodiment, the rotor further includes magnetic flux barriers arranged at each end of each slot of the first and second groups of slots, two half shafts enclosing the stack of laminations and forming a shaft of the rotor, the rotor being a non-through shaft rotor, two non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disks, each non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disk being interposed between one end of the stack and a half shaft, and a first set of tie rods connecting the two half shafts to keep the laminations of the stack compacted between the two half-shafts, each tie rod of the first set of tie rods being arranged between two adjacent slots of the first or second groups of slots.

[0020] Advantageously, at least some slots of the second group of slots closest to the periphery of the stack of laminations comprise non-magnetic and electrically insulating blocks.

[0021] According to an embodiment, each half shaft includes a flange in contact with a non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disk, the rotor further comprising a non-magnetic retaining ring enclosing the stack of laminations and partially the flanges of the half shafts, the diameter of the laminations being smaller than the diameter of the flanges so that the inner surface of the retaining ring is in contact with the peripheral surface of the flanges, the retaining ring being made of a non-magnetic and electrically insulating material.

[0022] Advantageously, the retaining ring is made of a stainless-steel.

[0023] According to an embodiment, the retaining ring is made of composite fibers.

[0024] Advantageously, the laminations of the stack are separated by at least one intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disk in two sub-stacks of laminations, the diameter of the intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disk being equal to the diameter of the flanges so that the retaining ring is in contact the peripheral surface of the intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disk.

[0025] Advantageously, the intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disks are made of stainless-steel.

[0026] According to an embodiment, the intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disks are made of composite materials.

[0027] According to an embodiment, the cylindrical stack is divided in a longitudinal direction of the stack by a plane including a rotation axis of the rotor in two similar half cylinders, the first pole being arranged in a first half cylinder, the second pole being arranged in the second half cylinder and similar to the first pole, the first and second groups of slots of the first pole and the first and second groups of slots of the second pole being symmetrical with respect to the plane, tie rods of the first groups of tie rods being arranged between the first and the second poles.

[0028] Advantageously, the rotor comprises a third pole and a fourth pole similar to the first pole, the second pole being similar to the first pole, wherein the cylindrical stack is divided in a longitudinal direction of the stack in four similar cylindrical portions, the first pole being arranged in a first cylindrical portion, the second pole being arranged in a second cylindrical portion, the third pole being arranged in a third cylindrical portion, the fourth pole being arranged in the fourth cylindrical portion, so that the first and second groups of slots of the first pole and the first and second groups of slots of the second pole are symmetrical with respect to a first plane including a rotation axis of the rotor, and the first and second groups of slots of the third and fourth poles and

the first and second groups of slots of the first and second poles are symmetrical with respect to a second symmetrical plane including the rotation axis of the rotor and perpendicular to the first plane.

[0029] According to an embodiment, the rotor further comprises a third group of slots extending along the rotation axis of the rotor and lodging second permanent magnets.

[0030] Advantageously, the rotor comprises a fourth group of slots, each slot of the fourth group of slots extending between the rotation axis of the rotor and the peripheral surface of the stack and being oriented according to the first or second plane, each slot of the fourth group of slots comprising third permanent magnets and magnetic flux barriers arranged at the end of each slot of the fourth group of slots near the peripheral surface of the stack.

[0031] According to an embodiment, the rotor further comprises a second set of tie rods, arranged between the rotation axis of the rotor and the first, second, third and fourth poles, and between the slots of the third group of slots.

[0032] Another embodiment of the invention relates to an electric machine comprising a stator and rotor as defined above, the rotor being inserted in the stator.

[0033] Another embodiment of the invention relates to a motor compressor comprising an electric machine as defined above and a compression section, the rotor being connected to the compression section.

[0034] Another embodiment of the invention relates to a magnetic coupling comprising a rotor as defined above and an external rotor, the rotor being inserted in the external rotor.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0035] Other characteristics and advantages of the invention will emerge on reading the following description of embodiments of the invention, provided solely by way of non-limiting examples and with reference to the drawings in which:

[0036] FIG. 1 illustrates an embodiment of a motor compressor according to the invention,

[0037] FIGS. 2 and 3 illustrate schematically a first embodiment of a rotor according to the invention,

[0038] FIG. 4 illustrates schematically a second embodiment of a rotor according to the invention,

[0039] FIG. 5 illustrates schematically a third embodiment of a rotor according to the invention, and

[0040] FIG. 6 illustrates schematically an embodiment of a magnetic coupling according to the invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0041] FIG. 1 illustrates an embodiment of a motor compressor 1.

[0042] The motor compressor 1 comprises a compression section 2 intended to compress a gas and an electric machine 3.

[0043] The electric machine 3 comprises a stator 4 and a rotor 5 lodged in the stator.

[0044] The rotor 5 comprises first permanent magnets, the electric machine 3 being a synchronous permanent magnet electric machine 3.

[0045] The rotor 5 is connected to a shaft of the compression section 2 to drive the compression section 2.

[0046] The electric machine 3 may drive another mechanical system.

[0047] In another embodiment, the rotor 5 of the electric machine 3 is driven by a motor system to generate electric energy.

[0048] FIGS. 2 and 3 illustrate schematically cross sections of a first embodiment of the rotor 5 with respect to a longitudinal and a radial directions of the rotor 5, the rotor 5 being a two poles

permanent magnet rotor.

[0049] As illustrated on FIG. 2, the rotor 5 comprises two half shafts 6 enclosing a cylindrical stack 7 of laminations 8.

[0050] The two half shafts 6 form a shaft of the rotor 5, the rotor 5 being a non-through shaft rotor.

[0051] Each lamination 8 refers to thin metal plates or other thin plates, a plurality of which are typically stacked and adhered together to form the cylindrical stack 7.

[0052] The laminations 8 are made of a suitable ferromagnetic material, such as may have low loss and high mechanical strength suitable for substantially high rotational speeds.

[0053] The rotor 5 further comprises two non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disks 9, each non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disk 9 being arranged at an end of the cylindrical stack 7.

[0054] Each half shaft 6 comprises a flange 10 and a shaft 11 connected to a first face of the flange 10.

[0055] The shaft 11 of one of the half shafts 6 is connected to the shaft of the compression section 2.

[0056] The second face of each flange 10 is in contact with one non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disk 9.

[0057] As detailed in the following, the rotor 5 further comprises first groups of slots and second groups of slots arranged in the magnetic mass to form poles.

[0058] Some slots of the first group of slots comprise first permanent magnets 12 and some slots of the second group of slots comprise first permanent magnets 12.

[0059] The non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disks 9 positioned at the ends of the stack 7 prevent that axial magnetic flux generated by the first permanent magnets leak into the half shafts 6.

[0060] The non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disks 9 are of materials resisting to the pre-stressing forces of the stack 7 of laminations 8 and have low magnetic permeability, for embodiment the non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disks 9 are made of austenitic stainless steel.

[0061] The rotor 5 further comprises a first set of tie rods 100 connecting the two half shafts 6 to keep the laminations 8 of the stack 7 compacted between the two half-shafts 6 and going through holes of the laminations 8.

[0062] Each tie rod 100 of the first set of tie rods is arranged between two adjacent slots of the first or second groups of slots.

[0063] The first set of tie rods 100 may be screwed or bolted in the half shafts 6.

[0064] The rotor 5 may further comprise a non-magnetic retaining ring 13 enclosing the stack 7 of laminations 8 and partially the flanges 10 of the half shafts, 6.

[0065] The diameter of the laminations 8 is smaller than the diameter of the flanges 10 so that the inner surface of the retaining ring 13 is in contact with the peripheral surface of the flanges 10.

[0066] The retaining ring 13 is made of a non-magnetic and electrically insulating material, for example stainless-steel or composite fibers such as thermoplastic carbon fibers.

[0067] The retaining ring 13 retains the laminations 8 and the magnets expelled out of the rotor 5 under the effect of centrifugal forces.

[0068] The rotor 5 comprising the half shafts 6 and the retaining ring 13 may rotate at rotating speeds such that the peripheral speed of the rotor 5 is greater than 200 m.Math.s.sup.-1 increasing the power density of the rotor 5 compared to a permanent magnet rotor known from the prior art.

[0069] Further, as the diameter of the laminations 8 is smaller than the inner diameter of the retaining ring 13, the retaining ring 9 allows pre-stressing of the stack 7 of laminations 8.

[0070] The stack 7 may further comprise at least one intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disk 14 to separate the stack 7 in two sub-stacks of laminations 8.

[0071] As illustrated, the stack 7 comprises two intermediate non-magnetic and electrically

insulating disks **14** arranged in the stack **7** so that laminations **8** are divided in three sub-stacks having a same length L_s , the sum of the length L_s of the three sub-stacks being equal to the length L_t of the stack **7**.

[0072] In another embodiment, the length of each sub-stack may different, the sum of the lengths of the sub-stacks being equal to the length L_t of the stack **7**.

[0073] Each intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disk **14** may be made of a non-magnetic and electrically insulating material, for example stainless-steel or composite materials such as thermoplastic carbon fibers.

[0074] The stack **7** may comprise more than two intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disks **14**.

[0075] The diameter of the intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disks **14** is equal to the diameter of the flanges **10** so that the retaining ring **13** is in contact with the peripheral surface of the intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disks **14**.

[0076] The intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disks **14** homogenize the pre-stressing efforts of the first set of tie rods on the laminations **8** and are made for example of non-magnetic stainless steel.

[0077] As illustrated on FIG. **3**, the cylindrical stack is divided in a longitudinal direction by a plane PL1 including the rotation axis A in two similar half cylinders C1, C2.

[0078] A first pole P1 is arranged in a first half cylinder C1 and the second pole P2 similar to the first pole P1 is arranged in the second half cylinder C2.

[0079] Each pole P1, P2 comprises a first group of slots **15**, **15a** and a second group of slots **16**, **16a** comprising first permanent magnets **12**.

[0080] As the two poles P1, P2 are similar, the first pole P1 is detailed as follows.

[0081] The first group of slots **15** are arranged to form a magnetic flux along a direct axis P of the first pole P1 resulting from the first and second group of slots **15**, **16**.

[0082] The second group **16** of slots is arranged to provide a separation for the magnetic flux from adjacent poles and lying along a quadrature axis Q of said first pole P1.

[0083] The slots of the second group **16** of slots are arranged from either side of the slots of the first group **15**.

[0084] The direct axis P is the axis by which flux is produced by the magnets **14** in the first group **15** of slots.

[0085] As the rotor **5** is a two poles permanent magnet rotor, the quadrature axis Q is the axis perpendicularly positioned relative to the direct axis P. The quadrature axis Q is angularly centered between two adjacent poles P1, P2.

[0086] The angle between the direct axis P and the quadrature axis Q is equal to 180° divided by the number of poles, the number of poles being an even number, the poles forming pair(s) of poles.

[0087] For example, for a two poles rotor forming a pair of poles such as the rotor **5**, the angle between the direct axis P and the quadrature axis Q is equal to 90° , for a four poles rotor, the angle between the direct axis P and the quadrature axis Q is equal to 45° , and for a six poles rotor, the angle between the direct axis P and the quadrature axis Q is equal to 30° .

[0088] The slots of the first group **15** of slots are arranged perpendicular to the direct axis P.

[0089] According to an embodiment, at least some slots of the first group of slots are arranged to receive a respective first permanent magnet **14**. As illustrated, each of the first group of slots **15** includes a first permanent magnet **14**.

[0090] The slots of the first group **15** of slots may be stacked one on the other along the direct axis P in an ascending order of the length of the slots of the first group **15** of slots perpendicular to the direct axis P, the slot of the first group **15** of slots having the greatest length perpendicular to the direct axis P being the closest to the rotation axis A, and the slot of the first group **15** of slots having the smallest length perpendicular to the direct axis P being the closest to the periphery of the laminations **8**.

[0091] At least some of the second group **16** of slots may be arranged with respective first permanent magnet **12**. In one embodiment, as represented on FIG. **3**, each slot of the second group of slots **16** includes a first permanent magnet **12**. This arrangement results in a maximal magnetic field generated by the poles **P1**, **P2**.

[0092] At least some of the second group of slots **16** extend from a respective transition post (e.g., transition post **18**) configured to mechanically transition from the first group **15** of slots to the second group **16** of slots. That is, each transition post provides a structural member between one of the first group **15** of slots and an adjacent one of the second group **16** of slots, to buttress against expected mechanical forces.

[0093] Each slot of the second group **16** that extends from a respective transition post may include a section slantingly extending relative to a radius passing through a corresponding opening lodging a tie rod of the first set located along the path of the magnetic flux along the quadrature axis **Q**.

[0094] The slots of the second group **16** of slots may be made up of a pair of slots, such as slot pair **19** and **20** that extends from a respective center post **21**.

[0095] Magnetic flux barriers **22** are arranged at each end of each slot of the first and second groups **15**, **16** to prevent axial magnetic flux generated by the first permanent magnets **12** from looping in the laminations **7** so that that the magnetic flux generating a torque on the shaft **11** of the half shafts **6** is maximal.

[0096] The magnetic flux barriers **22** may be air or non-magnetic and electrically insulating wedges inserted in the ends of the slots.

[0097] The first and second groups **15**, **16** of the first pole **P1** and the first and second groups **15a**, **16a** of slots of the second pole **P2** are symmetrical with respect to the plane **PL1**.

[0098] Some tie rods **100** of the first groups of tie rods are arranged between the first and the second poles **P1**, **P2**.

[0099] As the rotor **5** comprises a non through rotor shaft made of the two half shafts **6**, the laminations **8** do not comprise a center hole to lodge a through rotor shaft so that the first and second groups **15**, **16** comprise more slots than permanent rotors known from the prior art without modifying the dimensions of the rotor **5**.

[0100] The volume of first permanent magnets **12** arranged on the first and second groups **15**, **16** of the poles **P1**, **P2** is increased so that the magnetic flux delivered by the rotor **5** is increased compared to the permanent magnet rotor known from the prior art increasing the torque delivered by the electric machine **3** on the shaft **11** of the half shafts **6**.

[0101] As the torque delivered by the machine **3** is increased without modifying the encumbrance of the machine **2**, the power density of the machine **3** is increased compared to a permanent magnet machine known from the prior art.

[0102] The first permanent magnets **12** and the wedges inserted in the ends of the slots may be securely join with the laminations **8** to avoid that the first permanent magnets **12** move in the slots under the effect of the centrifugal forces.

[0103] The first permanent magnets **12** and the wedges are for example bonded in the slots.

[0104] The thickness of the retaining ring **13** is chosen as thick as possible to increase the amplitude of the magnetic induction in the air gap of the machine **3** generated by the first permanent magnets buried in the stack **7**.

[0105] Further, as the thickness of the retaining ring **13** is reduced, the rotor **5** comprises more permanent magnets **12** compared to a rotor known from the prior art having the same dimensions than the rotor **5**.

[0106] FIG. **4** illustrates schematically a cross section of a second embodiment of the rotor **5** with respect to a radial direction of the rotor **5**.

[0107] The second embodiment of the rotor **5** differs from the first embodiment of the rotor **5** illustrated on FIGS. **2** and **3** in that the slots **21** of the second group **16** of the first and second poles **P1**, **P2** closest to the periphery of the stack of laminations comprises non-magnetic and electrically

insulating blocks **23** replacing first permanent magnets **12**.

[0108] Some slots **24** of the second group **16** of the first and second poles **P1**, **P2** may comprise a first permanent magnet **12** and a non-magnetic and electrically insulating block **23**.

[0109] In another embodiment, some slots of the second group of slots of the poles **P1**, **P2** comprise the blocks **23** in the place of first permanent magnet **12**.

[0110] Replacing wholly or partially the first permanent magnets **12** in some slots of the second group **16** of the first and second poles **P1**, **P2** reduces the quantity of first permanent magnets **12** in the rotor **5** while preserving the salience saliency effect.

[0111] The number of first permanent magnets **12** of the second groups **16** replaced by blocks **23** are determined so that the magnetic flux generated by the first permanent magnets **12** in the rotor **5** is enough to drive a mechanical system connected to one of the said half shafts, for example the compression section **2**, or to generated a required electric energy when the rotor **5** is driven by a motor system.

[0112] The block **23** inserted in the slots of the second group **16** may be securely join with the laminations **8** to avoid that the blocks **23** move in the slots under the effect of the centrifugal forces.

[0113] The blocks **23** are for example bonded in the slots.

[0114] FIG. **5** illustrates schematically a cross section of a third embodiment of the rotor **5** with respect to a radial direction of the rotor **5**.

[0115] The rotor **5** comprises the first and second poles **P1**, **P2** comprising the first and second groups of slots, a third and a fourth pole **P3**, **P4** similar to the first and second poles **P1**, **P2**.

[0116] The machine **3** comprising the rotor **5** is a four poles synchronous permanent magnet machine.

[0117] The cylindrical stack **7** is divided in a longitudinal direction of the stack **7** in four similar cylindrical portions **C10**, **C11**, **C12**, **C13**.

[0118] The first pole **P1** is arranged in a first cylindrical portion **C10**, the second pole **P2** is arranged in a second cylindrical portion **C11**, the third pole **P3** is arranged in a third cylindrical portion **C13**, and the fourth pole **P4** is arranged in the fourth cylindrical portion **C14**.

[0119] The poles **P1**, **P2**, **P3**, **P4** are arranged in the cylindrical portions **C10**, **C11**, **C12**, **13** so that the first and second groups **15**, **16** of slots of the first pole **P1** and the first and second groups **15a**, **16a** of slots of the second pole **P2** are symmetrical with respect to a first plane **PL10** including the rotation axis **A** of the rotor **5**, and so that the first and second groups **15b**, **15c**, **16b**, **16c** of slots of the third and fourth poles **P3**, **P4** and the first and second groups **15**, **15a**, **16**, **16a** of slots of the first and second poles **P1**, **P2** are symmetrical with respect to a second symmetrical plane **PL20** including the rotation axis **A** and perpendicular to the first plane **PL10**.

[0120] Slots of the first and second groups **15**, **15a**, **15b**, **15c**, **16**, **16a**, **16b**, **16c** of slots of the poles **P1**, **P2**, **P3**, **P4** include permanent magnets **12**.

[0121] The rotor **5** may further comprise a third group of slots **25** extending along the rotation axis **A** of the rotor **5** and lodging a rod **26** made of a non-magnetic and electrically insulating material, for example stainless-steel or composite materials such as thermoplastic carbon fibers. The rod **26** and the slots **25** may be cylindrical.

[0122] The rotor **5** may further comprise a fourth group of slots **27a**, **27b**, **27c**, **27d**.

[0123] Each slot **27a**, **27b**, **27c**, **27d** of the fourth group of slots extends between the rotation axis **A** of the rotor **5** and the peripheral surface of the stack **7**.

[0124] A first and a second slots **27a**, **27b** of the fourth group are oriented according to the first plane **P10**, and a third and a fourth slots **27c**, **27d** of the fourth group are oriented according to the second plane **P20**.

[0125] The first slot **27a** of the fourth group is arranged between the first pole **P1** and the second pole **P2**, the second slot **27b** of the fourth group is arranged between the third pole **P3** and the fourth pole **P4**, the third slot **27c** of the fourth group is arranged between the second pole **P2** and the third pole **P3**, and the fourth slot **27d** of the fourth group is arranged between the first pole **P1**

and the fourth pole P4.

[0126] Each slot 27a, 27b, 27c, 27d of the fourth group of slots comprises third permanent magnets 28 and magnetic flux barriers 29 arranged at the end of the said slot 27a, 27b, 27c, 27d near the peripheral surface of the stack 7.

[0127] The rod 26 and the slots 25 may be cylindrical. The rod 26 prevents the leaking of the magnetic flux generated by the third permanent magnets.

[0128] The rotor 5 comprising the first and second groups 15, 15a, 15b, 15c, 16, 16a, 16b, 16c of slots of the poles P1, P2, P3, P4 including permanent magnets 12 and the fourth group of slots 27a, 27b, 27c, 27d including third permanent magnets 28 and magnetic flux barriers 29 forms a rotor combining a multi-layer rotor type known from the prior art and a flux concentration type from the prior art. The rotor 5 comprises more permanent magnets as rotors known from the prior art.

[0129] As the torque density of the machine 3 is proportional to the magnetic flux generated by the magnets of the rotor 5, the torque density of the machine 3 is increased compared to a machine known from the prior art having the same encumbrance as the machine 3.

[0130] The third permanent magnets 28 add a field alignment torque in the direct axis of each pole P1, P2, P3, P4 and a reluctant torque in the quadrature axis of each pole P1, P2, P3, P4 to maximize the amount of torque generated by the rotor 5.

[0131] The second and third permanent magnets 26, 28 inserted in the ends of the slots may be securely joined with the laminations 8 to avoid that the second and third permanent magnets 26, 28 move in the slots under the effect of the centrifugal forces.

[0132] The second and third permanent magnets 26, 28 are for example bonded in the slots.

[0133] The stack 7 further comprises a second set of tie rods 30 arranged between the rotation axis A of the rotor and the first, second, third and fourth poles P1, P2, P3, P4, and between the slots of the fourth group of slots 27a, 27b, 27c, 27d.

[0134] The second set of tie rods 30 connect the two non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disks 9 to keep the laminations 8 of the stack 7 compacted between the non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disks 9 and going through holes of the laminations 8.

[0135] The second set of tie rods 30 may be screwed or bolted in the non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disks 9.

[0136] In another embodiment, the rotor 5 may comprise more than four poles, the cylindrical stack 7 being divided accordingly, the number of poles being an even number. The cylindrical stack 7 is divided in a longitudinal direction of the stack 7 in identical cylindrical portions, the number of cylindrical portions being equal to the number of poles, each pole being arranged in a cylindrical portion. The first and second groups of slots of one pole and the first and second groups of slots of an adjacent pole are symmetrical with respect to a plane including the rotation axis A of the rotor 5, the plane separating the cylindrical portions of the said one pole and the said adjacent pole.

[0137] FIG. 6 illustrates an embodiment of a magnetic coupling 40.

[0138] The magnetic coupling 40 comprises an external rotor 41.

[0139] The rotor 5 is inserted in the external rotor 41.

[0140] The torque applied to one of the rotor 5 and external rotor 41 is transferred through an air gap to the other rotor.

Claims

1. A rotor comprising: a cylindrical stack of laminations including: at least a first group of slots and a second group of slots arranged to form a first pole, the first group of slots being arranged to form a magnetic flux along a direct axis of the pole resulting from the first and second group of slots, at least some of the first group of slots comprising first permanent magnets, the second group of slots being arranged to provide a separation for the magnetic flux from adjacent poles and lying along a quadrature axis of said pole, at least some slots of the second group of slots comprising first

permanent magnets, and at least a second pole, the first pole and the second pole forming a pair of poles of the rotor, magnetic flux barriers arranged at each end of each slot of the first and second groups of slots, two half shafts enclosing the stack of laminations and forming a shaft of the rotor, the rotor being a non-through shaft rotor, two non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disks, each non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disk being interposed between one end of the stack and a half shaft, and a first set of tie rods connecting the two half shafts to keep the laminations of the stack compacted between the two half-shafts, each tie rod of the first set of tie rods being arranged between two adjacent slots of the first group of slots or second groups of slots.

2. The rotor according to claim 1, wherein at least some slots of the second group of slots closest to the periphery of the cylindrical stack of laminations comprises non-magnetic and electrically insulating blocks.

3. The rotor according to claim 2, wherein each half shaft comprises: a flange in contact with a non-magnetic and electrically insulating end disk, and the rotor further comprising: a non-magnetic retaining ring enclosing the cylindrical stack of laminations and partially the flanges of the half shafts, the diameter of the laminations being smaller than the diameter of the flanges so that the inner surface of the retaining ring is in contact with the peripheral surface of the flanges, the retaining ring being made of a non-magnetic and electrically insulating material.

4. The rotor according to claim 3, wherein the retaining ring is made of a stainless-steel.

5. The rotor according to claim 3, wherein the retaining ring is made of composite fibers.

6. The rotor according to claim 5, wherein the laminations of the cylindrical stack are separated by at least one intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disk in two sub-stacks of laminations, the diameter of the intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disk being equal to the diameter of the flanges so that the retaining ring is in contact the peripheral surface of the intermediate non-magnetic and electrically insulating disk.

7. The rotor according to claim 6, wherein the cylindrical stack is divided in a longitudinal direction of the stack by a plane including a rotation axis of the rotor in two similar half cylinders, the first pole being arranged in a first half cylinder, the second pole being arranged in the second half cylinder and similar to the first pole, the first and second groups of slots of the first pole and the first and second groups of slots of the second pole being symmetrical with respect to the plane, tie rods of the first groups of tie rods being arranged between the first and the second poles.

8. The rotor according to claim 6, further comprising: a third pole and a fourth pole being identical to the first pole, the second pole being identical to the first pole, wherein the cylindrical stack is divided in a longitudinal direction of the cylindrical stack in four identical cylindrical portions, the first pole being arranged in a first cylindrical portion, the second pole being arranged in a second cylindrical portion, the third pole being arranged in a third cylindrical portion, the fourth pole being arranged in the fourth cylindrical portion, so that the first and second groups of slots of the first pole and the first and second groups of slots of the second pole are symmetrical with respect to a first plane including a rotation axis of the rotor, and the first and second groups of slots of the third and fourth poles and the first and second groups of slots of the first and second poles are symmetrical with respect to a second symmetrical plane including the rotation axis of the rotor and perpendicular to the first plane.

9. The rotor according to claim 8, further comprising a third group of slots extending along the rotation axis of the rotor and lodging second permanent magnets.

10. The rotor according to claim 9, further comprising a fourth group of slots, each slot of the fourth group of slots extending between the rotation axis of the rotor and the peripheral surface of the cylindrical stack and being oriented according to the first or second plane, each slot of the fourth group of slots comprising third permanent magnets and magnetic flux barriers arranged at the end of each slot of the fourth group of slots near the peripheral surface of the stack.

11. The rotor according to claim 10, further comprising a second set of tie rods, arranged between the rotation axis of the rotor and the first, second, third and fourth poles, and between the slots of

the fourth group of slots.

12. An electric machine comprising a stator and rotor according to claim 1, the rotor being inserted in the stator.

13. A motor compressor comprising an electric machine according to claim 12, and a compression section, the rotor being connected to the compression section.

14. A magnetic coupling comprising a rotor according to claim 1, and an external rotor, the rotor being inserted in the external rotor.
